

**Printing problems, tackling viruses, connecting PCs,
a forgetful BIOS and much more—find your answers here**

XP Startup disk

Q. I have installed Windows XP Professional on my PC and want to create a Startup Disk, but there is no option to create it. Please tell me how I can create a boot floppy.

Suman Saha

Via e-mail

A To create a boot floppy for Windows XP, format it first from Windows XP by typing **format a:** at the command prompt. Copy the Ntldr, Ntdetect.com and boot.ini files from the root of the boot drive. If you are using a SCSI hard disk, copy the driver for the SCSI controller to the floppy and rename it Ntbootdd.sys. You can now start your computer by booting from this floppy disk.

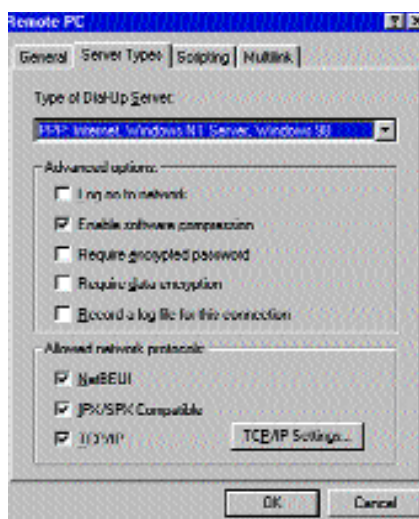
I'm DUN for

Q. When I connect to my ISP using a dial-up connection, the username and password gets verified, but the 'Logging on to network' dialog box remains on the screen for over a minute. Can you help me out with this?

Buzz

Via e-mail

A All you have to do is disable the 'Log on to Network' option in the dial-up connection's settings. To do this, open **Start > Programs > Accessories > Communications > Dial-Up Networking**, right-click the connection and click Properties. Under the Server Types tab, disable this option. Windows will no longer try to log on to the network and you will be



Browse the Internet without logging on to the network

able to use the Internet without any problems. Also note that if you leave this option enabled, you can start surfing as soon as the modem connects, without waiting for the 'Logging on to network' dialog box to disappear.

Stacked

Q. While working with Internet Explorer, I get the following error message quite frequently: 'Terminating thread due to stack overflow problem. A vxd consumed too much stack space. Increase setting of MinSPs in System.ini or remove recently installed vxds. There are currently 6 SPs allocated. Hit any key to proceed.' The computer seems to hang for a while and

then works properly. Please give me a solution to this problem.

Navin Kumar

Via e-mail

A This happens when Windows enters an internal overflow of stacks under 32-bit Windows-based drivers—usually due to a fault in the driver itself. Drivers are allocated 4 KB of memory to be used as a stack and if it uses more than that, a stack overflow occurs. By default, Windows sets aside two spare stacks to be used temporarily so that the computer does not hang. If Windows detects that it has run out of spare stack pages, you receive the aforementioned error message.

To solve the problem, add **MinSPs** to the [386Enh] section of C:\Windows\System.ini file. You can continue increasing the spare stack from here by increasing the number of MinSPs. You will have to restart the computer after editing the file for the changes to take effect. However, you should get up-to-date drivers for all your hardware to make sure that you are not using buggy software that could be harmful in the long run.

Corrupted e-mail

Q. I have been using Outlook Express the last two years. I had around 6,000 messages in my inbox, but due to power outage, it got corrupted. It is now showing only a few messages. The size of the file (inbox.rst) is 150 MB. Can my messages be recovered?

Yash Garg

Via e-mail